



GPS devices

As a standalone device, GPS navigators only appeal to those who really don't want to take any risks with navigation quality or consistency. To be honest, most people make do with apps on their smartphones.

Keeping that mind, GPS manufacturers have also provided apps. MapmyIndia has Maps on Mobile app for Android and Windows, with live traffic updated, while Sygic also used MapmyIndia maps for its very competent Android and iOS apps. Tom Tom upgraded the India app, which now is better than ever before, pretty much in-line with their extremely good standalone navigators.

Which neatly brings us to the topic of discussion - which is the best GPS navigator that we have tested this year. Well, the competition was tough throughout, to say the least. Last year, Satguide was a fairly important player, but this year, they seem to have taken a couple of steps back. No major navigation device launches from them, primarily. MapmyIndia trimmed the lineup, and added some rather competent devices - the Lx340 and the Zx350, the successor to our favorite, the Zx250. Tom Tom's new maps graced the VIA line-up, that has been carried on without any hardware change. However, the good aspects like quick boot and the readiness to navigate remain. Garmin added the Nuvi 2568LM to the product line-up, the successor to the very competent 2565LM, along with a few more affordable devices.

Navigation quality has improved considerably, with maps being updated more often, and more regions being covered. MapmyIndia's 3D Maps are pretty much unmatched. But, for the drivers, neat features like lane guidance are worth every penny spent on buying a navigator.

Zero1 Winner Tom Tom VIA 125

We just love these TomTom devices, and while these maps aren't 3D, they still look gorgeous and very much usable. Each VIA series navigator just goes about doing what it's supposed to do, in a very precise fashion. German precision, almost! And the VIA 125, with the bigger screen, is the best performer this year. Switch on any of the VIA devices, and it opens up straight on the Maps application. And straightaway, you are good to go. Extremely quick GPS lock times help as well. The amazingly clean UI is easy to navigate even for a newbie. The fact that we don't have to tap on a map app to start the navigation is one



TOM TOM VIA 125 ▲
Price: ₹14,000



step less. Voice guidance is at par with MapMyIndia devices, which is a huge positive.

Notable Mentions

Garmin nuvi 2568LM

Last year, the nuvi 2565LM was by far the best navigation device as far as map clarity and navigation precision is concerned. This time around, the updated nuvi 2568LM just takes the game further. The navigation quality is very good, be it on the main roads, a national highways or roads inside a colony. Navigation is precise - the nuvi 2568LM was the closest to the actual destination when it announced "you have reached your destination", in comparison to all other navigators. The impressive set of features are carried forward as is, but in a more streamlined UI - fuel average calculator, trends to guess where you may be going and little bits like currency converter, calculator, Bluetooth for phone calls, ability to customize the menu, etc. The UI is easy to navigate, thanks to a heady mix of big icons and clear text. This device is compatible with the rear parking camera, and Garmin packs in lifetime map updates with the device.



Garmin nuvi 2568LM

Price: ₹18,000



MapmyIndia VX140s Premium

Price: ₹10,000

MapmyIndia VX140s Premium

On cue with the price tag, the VX140s is true to its name - premium finish and a very sophisticated design. This device has received map upgrades that bring 3D landmarks and complete 2D maps. The interface is simple to get around, and MapmyIndia's prowess with address search makes this somewhat affordable (compared to the other two) navigator a rather good deal.